Cheat Sheet: MCP Server

Estimated time needed: 10 minutes

This module covered the basics of creating and configuring MCP Servers. Use this cheat sheet to quickly review and refresh the concepts you learned.

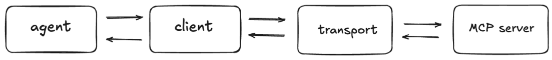
Transports

Overview

In MCP, the client and transport work together to carry messages between the AI application and the MCP server. The client acts as the translator and coordinator. It understands what the application needs, formats those requests correctly, and interprets the responses it receives. It also knows the MCP rules and ensures communication follows them.

The transport, on the other hand, is simply the path or communication channel that messages travel through, such as a WebSocket or a pipe. It does not understand the meaning of the messages. It simply delivers them back and forth reliably.

So, the client handles the logic and protocol, while the transport manages the low-level message delivery.



The Model Context Protocol (MCP) communicates using the JSON-RPC format. But how does this information travel between the client and the server? MCP supports two standardized transports: **STDIO** and **HTTP**.

STDIO